



Bill Gates is building his own smart city

The Billionaire has purchased around 25,000 acres of land in Phoenix, Arizona to build project Belmont
<http://digit.in/BG-SCity>



IBM's 50-qubit quantum computer

The company made the announcement at the IEEE Industry Summit on the Future of Computing
<http://digit.in/IBM-CC>

Google Pixel 2 XL

Too expensive for what it offers

Google's quest to become a mobile hardware behemoth depends heavily on software, particularly including AI and machine learning. And that should tell you everything you need to know about the Pixel 2 XL. It's high-end mobile hardware, driven by artificial intelligence and machine learning. But is the world, and especially India, ready for a device like this?

Build and features

The Google Assistant is always listening on the Pixel 2, and it tells you songs that are playing around you all day long. Now Playing is quite accurate too. It did fail a few times, but it took some doing to beat Google's knowledge database. Now Playing works offline, identifying music off a database that's pre-built into the Pixel 2 XL. With its \$1.1 billion investment in buying HTC's teams, Google also used its edge-squeeze feature on the Pixel 2 and Pixel 2 XL. With this, you squeeze the edges to turn on Google Assistant. Moreover, with the Pixel 2 XL's wide form factor, we found it rather inconvenient to squeeze its edges when needed. On the Pixel 2, it's a lot easier.

Camera

Unlike Apple, Google actually tries to make the Pixel 2 and Pixel 2 XL feel the same. And a lot of that has to do with the fact that they have identical cameras. The 12 MP sensor on the back, accompanied by Google's AI and machine learning mumbo jumbo makes for an impressive shooter.

The photos do look dull on the phone's own display, but they can well and truly wow you otherwise. Google's algorithms are somehow good enough to manage colour differentiation even in shadow areas on low light shots,



Price
₹73,000



FEATURE.....	76
PERFORMANCE.....	86
VALUE.....	59
DESIGN.....	74

something phones like the Galaxy Note 8 promptly ignore. There's some finer noise that you can see when you zoom in. In that state, edges may look somewhat soft, but that's not really a practical use-case. And Google knows that. The Pixel 2/XL's is

designed to put a nail in the point and shoot coffin once and for all. Though the phone does that, it doesn't necessarily improve on point and shoot cameras overall.

Performance

It's a fact that Android phones slow down over time. Believe it or not, the Pixel 2 XL will too. But it's fast out of the box. The Snapdragon 835 is the fastest processor you can find and the phone powers through most everything you can throw at it. App load times are the lowest Android can offer today and lags and frame drops are non-existent. For those wondering, the Pixel 2 XL also comes on top of benchmarks, and yes, it's not as powerful as the 2017 iPhones, on paper.

If you're looking for a fast Android phone, the Pixel 2 XL is certainly one of them. It has no heating issues, though it can get noticeably warm if you're downloading lots of apps together while performing other tasks. All things considered, the Pixel 2 XL is one of the fastest Android phones today. The question users like me will ask is, did it need to be the fastest? The answer likely, is yes

Battery life

Google promises a day's worth of battery life, and we concur with the same. However, we could get noticeably higher battery life from the Galaxy Note 8. On a busy work day, with two 15-minute Facebook Live sessions, seven phone calls, live-tweeting for 20 minutes, shooting two short 1080p videos and streaming music for 40 minutes, the Pixel 2 XL lasted us from 10 am to 5 pm. Is seven hours on heavy usage enough for you?

Verdict

Yes, the Google Pixel 2 XL has a class-leading camera, but it's also inconsistent. And that's an issue with this device. Combined with the sub-par display, the overall experience is rather disappointing and we can't recommend the Pixel 2 XL over its competition. So, the Pixel 2 XL is fast but not the fastest, it has a disappointing display, a great but inconsistent camera and average battery life. At ₹73,000, that doesn't make a very good value proposition. It's for sure a functional and even a good smartphone, but I'm not sure that's enough at this price. You could still buy the Pixel 2 XL for its excellent camera, but personally, I'm not convinced by it.

—Prasid Banerjee

SPECIFICATIONS

SOC: Snapdragon 835 | GPU: Adreno 540 | OS: Android 8.0 (Oreo) | CARD SLOT: NA | DISPLAY TYPE: P-OLED | SIZE: 6.0 inches | RESOLUTION: 1440 x 2880 pixels | CAMERA PRIMARY: 12.2 MP (f/1.8, 27mm, OIS) | CAMERA SECONDARY: 8 MP (f/2.4, 1.4 µm pixel size).

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